

Trailblazer: Dottin became the first woman to score a century in T20Is during a World T20 match against South Africa in 2010. EMMANUAL YOGINI

As a senior player, how do you mentor and support the younger players in the team?

The main message I try to share is the importance of being fearless. I always emphasise that you should be prepared to fail because if you're not ready for that possibility, you've already set yourself up for failure. When you're prepared to fail, the impact of failure won't feel as overwhelming. I also encourage them to work hard and approach the game with fearlessness. Many of them are determined, eager to learn, and aspire to play in franchise leagues. I always try to motivate them, reminding them to focus on what they can control and leave the rest in God's hands.

Despite a fine blend of youth and experience, the West Indies has been erratic in its performances. Where is it lacking?



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I definitely think it's about consistency. We need to be more consistent. I believe we have the experience. Not everyone may be highly experienced, but there are enough players around to help and support the younger ones who are willing to learn. What we have is talent and potential. But you can only go so far with talent and potential. If you can be

consistent, you will go even further. I think that is what we are lacking, and it's something we are actively working on.

What lessons did the team take away from the narrow semifinal loss to New Zealand in the T20 World Cup?

We were all on the same page and determined to win. We played really good cricket but it just wasn't our day and we lost narrowly.

However, I also know that more T20 World Cups are coming up, so we can definitely make a strong comeback.

In the Women's Premier League auction this year, you were roped in for a whopping Rs 1.70 crore. From withdrawing in 2023 and going unsold in 2024, you have come a long way in the franchise league...

Yeah, life has come full circle. I think everything happens for a reason. So, I was actually supposed to be in the 2025 WPL this time, and I will be there to showcase my talents and what I do best. It is

actually good to play in a franchise league because you always get that experience.

To play alongside players from different teams like India, a couple of Australians, and others, you get to learn more of other players' personalities and how they go about their games as well.

When you share the dressing room with international players from around the world, what do you focus on?

We actually learn a lot from other players because you may not have the setup that they have, but you make use of what you have in order to match up or probably be better. In the process, you do learn a lot. Some of them play shots differently, whereas you can take a leaf out of their style of play and how they go about their game as well. But it is not going to be exactly the same. It is just taking an example of their performance and seeing if you actually fit in and see if it works for you.

What are the targets that you have set for the WPL?

I have played in that tournament (Women's T20 Challenge) in India before. So, I do not think it is going to be that much different. It will probably be just playing in a different State or a few venues. But it is just a

